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Product Brief: Waklass SMS

Executive Summary

Waklass SMS is a web-based school management SaaS for primary and secondary schools in Cameroon, with the first release focused on bilingual secondary schools that need both anglophone and francophone education support. Its initial product promise is simple: help a school run an academic year from student enrollment through final report-card publication, while reducing the delays and errors that make report-card periods painful.

The first sellable version combines academic setup, marks entry, report-card generation, discipline follow-up, parent access, and school-fee tracking. Waklass is not trying to be a full payroll, inventory, library, or e-learning system in v1. It wins by making the core administrative cycle faster, more reliable, bilingual, and adapted to Cameroonian school realities.

The product must feel practical for real school conditions: principals need visibility, staff need fast data entry, parents need trustworthy access to published child information, and schools need flexible roles because every school organizes work differently. Waklass should support poor-connectivity workflows for marks and data entry, provide English and French interfaces and documents, and give schools

standard templates they can choose and switch between.

The Problem

Cameroonian schools often manage academic records, report cards, discipline, parent communication, and fee follow-up through a mix of paper, Excel, WhatsApp, and disconnected tools. This creates repeated work, slow reporting periods, avoidable mark errors, weak parent visibility, and difficulty tracking student progress across the year.

The pain becomes most visible at report-card time. Marks must be collected from teachers, checked, weighted with subject coefficients, ranked, formatted, printed, and sometimes corrected under pressure. If the process takes a week, administrators lose time, teachers are frustrated, and parents receive information too late to act.

Existing generic school platforms may cover parts of this workflow, but Waklass needs to fit the specific local context: bilingual schools, anglophone and francophone subsystems, term and sequence structures, variable exams inside a term, competency comments or skills on report cards, discipline follow-up, and school-fee realities.

The Solution

Waklass provides one shared SaaS platform where each school can configure its academic year, enroll students, assign classes and subjects, enter marks, generate report cards, publish parent-facing results, track discipline, and manage school-fee payments and balances.

For daily school staff, Waklass should prioritize fast entry and low friction: bulk Excel/CSV imports, spreadsheet-like marks entry, mobile marks entry, reusable setup from the previous year, automatic calculations, report-card templates, and one-click report-card publishing. Marks become locked after submission, and authorized profiles can unlock them when corrections are needed.

For parents, Waklass provides access to published report cards, discipline records, notifications, and child-related school information. Communication should prioritize WhatsApp first, then SMS, then push notifications, then email.

For Waklass operators, the product must support onboarding many schools into one shared SaaS environment without mixing their data. Each school operates as its own tenant with isolated users, students, academic setup, fees, documents, and reports.

Cameroon Education Context

Waklass must support bilingual school operations from day one: English and French UI, English and French report-card outputs, and configuration for anglophone and francophone academic structures.

The base academic model should support terms with sequences, while allowing schools to configure variable exams inside a term. Subjects have coefficients, averages are weighted, and report cards need class rank, subject rank, general average, and optional decision/pass/fail fields.

Competency-based reporting in v1 means comments and skills displayed on report cards, not a full replacement of numeric marks with competency grids. Comments are autogenerated: grades for anglophone second cycle and predefined comments for other cases.

Potential regulatory output remains to validate: "carnet scolaire" for francophone examination classes.

Who This Serves

The first ideal paying customers are bilingual secondary schools in Cameroon. Waklass should later scale to private primary schools, Catholic/mission schools, government schools, small schools around 200 students, and large schools around 2,000 students, but the first brief

target is secondary schools that are more likely to pay and have more complex reporting needs.

The primary administrator persona is the principal, who needs confidence that the school year is progressing, report cards can be produced on time, sensitive actions are controlled, and parents can access reliable information.

Daily users include teachers, class masters, discipline staff, secretariat/admin staff, bursar or fee-management staff, and other school-authorized staff. Parents are a secondary but important user group, especially for published report cards, discipline information, and notifications.

Core Product Scope

V1 must include:

- Enrollment and student registration with basic identity and parent information
- Class management and student promotion from one year to the next
- Subject setup, coefficients, and teacher-subject-class assignment
- Marks entry, weighted averages, ranking, and report-card generation/printing
- Report-card template selection, switching, publishing, and parent access
- Discipline records including incident log, sanctions, behavior score, parent notification, and report-card discipline information
- Parent portal for published report cards, discipline records, notifications, and child-related information
- School-fee tracking: fee setup, payments, receipts, balances, and debtors list
- Exports or reports for accountants, with fuller accounting left for later

School onboarding and setup must include:

- Creation of a school tenant by Waklass staff or an authorized platform administrator [ASSUMPTION]
- School profile setup: name, logo, address, language preference, education subsystem, and report-card identity
- Academic year setup with terms, sequences, and optional exams inside terms
- Class, subject, coefficient, staff, and role/profile setup
- Excel/CSV import for students, staff, classes, subjects, and initial fee data
- Reuse of prior-year setup when opening a new academic year

Academic-year lifecycle must include:

- Opening a new academic year
- Enrolling new students
- Promoting students to the next class
- Marking students as repeating, transferred, withdrawn, or inactive
- Archiving previous academic-year records while keeping them accessible for reporting
- Handling students who join during the year

Later scope:

- Timetable management
- Attendance tracking
- Fuller accounting features beyond school-fee tracking and accountant handoff

Not in v1:

- Staff payroll
- Inventory/library
- E-learning, online content, or tests

Workflow Requirements

Marks and report-card workflows must include readiness controls, not only final printing. Waklass should show completion status by class,

subject, teacher, and assessment period so school leaders can see missing marks before report cards are generated.

The report-card workflow should support:

- Teacher marks entry and submission
- Automatic locking after submission
- Authorized unlock and correction
- Missing marks dashboard
- Calculation preview before publication
- Bulk validation by authorized staff
- Print-ready PDF generation
- Report-card publication to parent accounts only when the school decides to publish
- Audit trail for mark changes, unlocks, validation, printing, and publication

Discipline workflow should support incident recording, sanctions, behavior score, parent notification, and inclusion of discipline information on report cards where the selected template requires it.

Access, Workflow, and Usability Principles

Waklass should use a role/profile and capability model. The system provides default profiles such as teacher, but schools can create custom profiles, attach profiles to staff members, and assign capabilities to profiles. This supports real school variation without hardcoding one hierarchy.

Sensitive actions must be audited, including mark edits, unlocks, report-card publication, discipline changes, and fee/payment changes. Submitted marks become locked; only authorized profiles can unlock or modify them afterward.

Because Waklass is a shared SaaS platform, tenant isolation is mandatory. Users from one school must not access another school's students, staff, fees, report cards, discipline records, or settings. Waklass support/admin access must be explicit, limited, and audited.

Parent access must support one parent or guardian viewing multiple children in the same school. Multi-school parent access is a later consideration [ASSUMPTION]. Parent onboarding should work through school-provided phone numbers and controlled invitation or activation flows, with support for phone-number changes.

The product must tolerate poor connectivity for marks and data entry. This does not yet define the technical architecture, but the product requirement is clear: users should not lose work or be blocked unnecessarily because internet quality is weak.

Ease and speed mean:

- Bulk imports from Excel/CSV
- Spreadsheet-like marks entry
- Reusable setup from the previous academic year
- Mobile marks entry
- Automatic calculations
- Standard templates
- One-click report-card publishing

Finance and Communication Requirements

V1 finance is school-fee tracking with accountant handoff, not a full accounting system. It must handle fee setup, student payments, receipts, balances, and debtors lists.

The fee model should account for common school scenarios:

- Class-specific fees
- Installments or tranches
- Partial payments
- Optional fees
- Discounts or scholarships
- Sibling discount support [ASSUMPTION]
- Payment reversals or corrections with audit trail
- Receipt numbering
- Exportable fee reports for accountants

Notification rules must be governed by permissions and templates. Waklass should support individual and bulk notifications for report-card publication, fee reminders, discipline alerts, and general school communication. Notification language should follow the school's selected language or the parent's preferred language where available [ASSUMPTION].

Initial channel priority is WhatsApp, SMS, push notifications, then email. Because WhatsApp and SMS may carry direct costs or provider constraints, notification sending should be trackable by school and message type.

Report Cards, Templates, and Documents

Waklass should provide standard report-card templates that schools can choose and switch between, rather than requiring each school to design from scratch.

Template coverage should include:

- Anglophone secondary report cards
- Francophone secondary report cards
- Bilingual school report-card needs
- Exam-class variants where required
- School logo and identity
- Signature and stamp areas
- Subject coefficients, averages, ranks, and optional decision/pass/fail fields
- Competency comments or skills
- Discipline information where required
- Print-ready PDF layout

The product should preserve published report cards as accessible records for the relevant academic year and term/sequence.

Import, Export, and Data Quality

Fast adoption depends on reliable import/export, not only manual forms.

V1 should support imports for:

- Students and parent information
- Staff
- Classes
- Subjects and coefficients
- Teacher-subject-class assignments
- Fee setup or opening balances
- Marks, where schools already collect them externally
[ASSUMPTION]

Imports must provide clear error feedback so schools can correct bad files without losing the entire import. Exports should include marks sheets, report-card data, debtor lists, payment records, receipts, and accountant-facing fee reports.

Non-Functional Requirements

Waklass must be reliable enough for school operations during peak reporting periods.

Minimum expectations:

- Strong tenant isolation across schools
- Role and capability enforcement on every sensitive action
- Audit logs for marks, report cards, discipline, payments, settings, and support access
- Regular backups and restore procedures
- Responsive web experience for desktop and mobile browsers
- Poor-connectivity tolerance for marks and data entry
- Reliable PDF generation for report cards and receipts
- Acceptable performance for schools with up to 2,000 students in v1 target conditions
- English and French translation quality suitable for official school documents
- Data retention for historical academic years

What Makes This Different

Waklass differentiates by being built around Cameroon school operations rather than generic school administration. The first release combines bilingual academic reporting, configurable assessment periods, report-card automation, discipline follow-up, parent visibility, and school-fee tracking in one workflow.

The strongest early wedge is report-card speed and reliability: helping schools prepare report cards in one day instead of one week, with fewer mark errors and clearer parent access.

The product should be flexible without becoming chaotic. Schools can configure profiles, permissions, templates, academic periods, and fee structures, but the experience should still guide them through the academic year.

Success Criteria

Waklass is working if the first schools can say, after one academic term, that:

- Report cards are prepared in one day instead of one week
- Mark errors are reduced
- Parents are checking published results and student information
- Fee follow-up is faster and debtors are easier to identify
- Principals and authorized staff trust the audit trail for sensitive actions
- Teachers and staff can enter data quickly, including under poor connectivity conditions

Open Questions

- What exact "carnet scolaire" requirements apply to francophone examination classes?
- Which report-card templates are needed first for anglophone, francophone, and bilingual secondary schools?
- What level of offline or poor-connectivity support is required for v1: draft saving, background sync, offline spreadsheet import, or something stronger?
- Which accountant export formats are required for school-fee reporting?
- What specific parent actions are allowed in v1 beyond viewing information and receiving notifications?
- Is school onboarding performed only by Waklass staff, or should schools eventually self-onboard?
- Should parent accounts work across multiple schools in v1 or only within one school?
- Which payment methods should v1 record: cash, bank transfer, mobile money, check, or all?
- Which WhatsApp/SMS providers are realistic for Cameroon delivery and pricing?